

| Krypton (16/10/40)                                        | LG GCE-8160B (16/10/40)                                          | Plextor PX-W2410TA                                                     | Samsung SW-224 BRNS (24/10/40)                               | Sony CRX175A1 (24/10/40)                                                                                                    | Yamaha CRW-2200 (20/10/40)                                         | Yamaha CRW 3200E-VK (24/10/40)                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 357                                                       | 330                                                              | 247                                                                    | 254                                                          | 251                                                                                                                         | 295                                                                | 244                                                                              |
| 315                                                       | 309                                                              | 232                                                                    | 240                                                          | 247                                                                                                                         | 284                                                                | 226                                                                              |
| 278                                                       | 276                                                              | 207                                                                    | 215                                                          | 214                                                                                                                         | 238                                                                | 200                                                                              |
| 323                                                       | 323                                                              | 232                                                                    | 235                                                          | 231                                                                                                                         | 285                                                                | 225                                                                              |
| Failed                                                    | 476                                                              | 480                                                                    | 476                                                          | 484                                                                                                                         | 471                                                                | 473                                                                              |
|                                                           |                                                                  |                                                                        |                                                              |                                                                                                                             |                                                                    |                                                                                  |
| 242                                                       | 138                                                              | 238                                                                    | 192                                                          | 154                                                                                                                         | 152                                                                | 145                                                                              |
| 161                                                       | 157                                                              | 157                                                                    | 166                                                          | 158                                                                                                                         | 172                                                                | 155                                                                              |
|                                                           |                                                                  |                                                                        |                                                              |                                                                                                                             |                                                                    |                                                                                  |
| 30.64                                                     | 30.94                                                            | 31.45                                                                  | 29.65                                                        | 30.23                                                                                                                       | 28.91                                                              | 30.16                                                                            |
| 90                                                        | 95                                                               | 134                                                                    | 80                                                           | 92                                                                                                                          | 130                                                                | 103                                                                              |
|                                                           |                                                                  |                                                                        |                                                              |                                                                                                                             |                                                                    |                                                                                  |
| 2 MB                                                      | 2 MB                                                             | 4 MB                                                                   | 2 MB                                                         | 2 MB                                                                                                                        | 8 MB                                                               | 8 MB                                                                             |
|                                                           |                                                                  |                                                                        |                                                              |                                                                                                                             |                                                                    |                                                                                  |
| NTI CD Maker v5, Ritek 10x 650 MB CD-RW                   | Adaptec Easy CD Creator 4.03, DirectCD 3.03, LG 10x 650 MB CD-RW | Nero v5.5, Plextor Manager 2000, 1 10x 650 MB CD-RW, 1 24x 700 MB CD-R | Nero v5.5, Samsung 10x 700 MB CD-RW, Samsung 24x 700 MB CD-R | B's Gold Recorder, B's Clip Writing Software, Retrospect Express, Music Match, Arcsoft Photo Base, Arcsoft Video Impression | Nero v5.5, NeroMIX, INCD, Yamaha 650 MB CD-RW, Yamaha 700 MB CD-R  | Nero v5.5, InCD, Nero Toolkit, Nero MIX, Yamaha 700 MB CD-R, Yamaha 650 MB CD-RW |
| <b>C+</b>                                                 | <b>B-</b>                                                        | <b>A-</b>                                                              | <b>A-</b>                                                    | <b>B</b>                                                                                                                    | <b>B</b>                                                           | <b>A+</b>                                                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                  |                                                                        | Samsung Electron-                                            |                                                                                                                             |                                                                    |                                                                                  |
| Priya International<br>022-2663611<br>jain@priyagroup.com | LG Electronics<br>022-6910123<br>sanjaym@lgindia.com             | Zeta Technologies<br>022-4102288<br>tejas@zetaindia.com                | ics India<br>011-6322517<br>marketing@samsungindia.com       | Rashi Peripherals<br>022-8260258<br>ho@rptechindia.com                                                                      | Integra Dataware P. Ltd.<br>022-8215179<br>mumbai@integramicro.com | Neoteric Informatique<br>022-4172600<br>sales@neoteric-info.com                  |
| 5,300                                                     | 6,365                                                            | 9,950                                                                  | 8,000                                                        | 10,000                                                                                                                      | 9,000                                                              | 15,000                                                                           |

The Samsung SW-224 BRNS (24/10/40) beat the others in terms of random access time, scoring a trim 80 ms whereas the rest clocked at about 100 ms.

A rather peculiar result was observed with the Asus CRW-2410S: it suffered in the audio extraction test, and crawled in last, taking all of 582 seconds (9 minutes 42 seconds) to rip from the audio CD. It churned out the same result when we reran the test. Nevertheless, we would give the drive the benefit of doubt since the average access time and the average read speeds were pretty much in line with the rest.

### External CD-Writers

If portability is what you want in a CD-Writer, then you should consider buying an external CD-Writer. These writers have been around for a while and are quite reliable.

Since portability is of the essence here, we weighed the external writers that came into our lab. Strangly, all the IDE writers weighed far less than most external CD-Writers.

The lightest was the aptly named Freecom Traveller CDRW Light (400 grams). However, the writer failed the

audio write and the RAW write tests. The scores for the other tests too were nothing to write home about.

The Kodak 4832e CDRW, weighing more than 2.5 kg, also failed to complete the RW Assorted test. It clocked 16 minutes and above in all the other tests, which is not surprising considering that this is a 4x writer.

The Yamaha CRW 2200IX-VK (20/10/40, Firewire) simply blew the competition away, with scores comparable to those of internal IDE writers; it even bettered some of the internal writers. It was

**The first CD-Writer** was sold for \$1,49,000. It burned CDs at 1x and was used to write only audio CDs. For data CDs it needed to have an additional circuit board which cost \$14,000. To write CDs it needed a machine called the publisher which was what we now know as the hard drive subsystem. This was where the writer read the data from. This publishing machine was as big as a washing machine.

not a cake walk for either of the Yamaha entries here though: the Impulse GCD 161049 (16/10/40) writer actually beat the Yamaha 2100SX-VK SCSI drive in all but one test.

One thing that you must keep in mind is that with external writers speed isn't everything. An easy-to-use interface and fast and easy configuration are far more important. The Acer CRW 4406EU came out trumps here. It uses the standard USB interface, is easy to configure and does not require any additional interface cards for it to function. Nor did it fail any test, though the scores were low due to the fact that it could write only at 4x speed. The only major gripe with it was the pathetically slow read speed of 6x.

**Choosing the right one**

Consistency is the name of the game. Unfailing consistency, predictability and data integrity that would give you sound sleep every time you burn that critical backup.

The scores throughout the test were a little inconsistent. You would see some writers perform brilliantly in some tests and then return really low scores in others. However, one writer stood out time